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AI policy in education is hardening from guidance into enforceable assessment rules

Fresh signals from schools, regulators, and ministries show AI use is now being governed through explicit constraints on assessment, student tooling, and teacher-led implementation.

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England's regulator warns AI is undermining how universities verify learning

England's Office for Students says pervasive AI use has made coursework assessment "close to impossible" in some areas and is urging institutions to increase AI-free exams, vivas, and in-person assessments. The Guardian.

The shift marks a broader move from AI-usage disclosure policies to redesigned assessment architecture that can still measure student knowledge reliably. Yahoo News Australia.

> *The policy center has moved from whether AI is allowed to how learning is still provable.*

Research & Evidence

Regulators are now treating AI assessment risk as a system-level quality issue

England's higher-ed regulator has signaled that weak AI-era assessment design may breach registration conditions, raising compliance pressure on institutions. The Guardian.

Universities report near-universal student AI use but uneven policy readiness

Analysis cited in Australia shows rapid adoption outpacing formal institutional governance and consistent assessment guidance. Yahoo News Australia.

Open-university AI skilling is scaling through distance learning channels

Kerala's SGOU and Saina Human AI signed to train over one lakh learners, highlighting workforce-facing AI education beyond campus programs. DigitalLEARNING.

Nordic Focus

NORWAY New reporting in Norway shows youth skepticism toward AI rising sharply, with students linking AI adoption to uncertainty about learning quality and career paths. NRK.

ICELAND Iceland's national AI proposal package keeps schools and skills among top priorities, including a national framework for AI in education. Iceland Review.

FINLAND Sanoma Learning's curriculum-aligned teacher assistant rollout includes Finland and Sweden, reinforcing demand for education-specific AI tools over generic assistants. Yahoo Finance.

Around the Globe

US The school AI debate remains focused on who controls student search exposure when AI is embedded in core platforms. The Hindu.

US Vendor competition is intensifying as privacy-first search alternatives position AI-off controls as an education feature. TechCrunch.

INDIA Andhra Pradesh's 50-lakh AI skilling plan ties school curriculum updates to credits, teacher preparation, and youth workforce pathways. DigitalLEARNING.

INDIA Kerala's open-university AI program shows adult and distance-learning channels becoming major AI capacity builders. DigitalLEARNING.

MACAU UNU Macau's upcoming conference is centering AI literacy, governance, and global-south participation across 74 countries and territories. UNU Macau.

SINGAPORE EDUtech Asia continues to frame AI implementation around human-centered pedagogy, employability, and practical governance choices. Bastille Post.

SOUTH AFRICA Wits is convening educators on AI's "hidden curriculum" effects, reflecting rising scrutiny of how AI shapes student thinking beyond outputs. htxt.

Tools & Platforms

AI-free assessment formats return to the core toolkit

Institutions are expanding in-person written exams, vivas, and process-based assessment to preserve evidence of authentic learning.

The Guardian

Search engines are now an AI-governance decision for schools

Schools are evaluating search products based on whether AI behaviors can be independently disabled for student accounts.

TechCrunch

Distance-learning AI skilling stacks are maturing

Open-university deployments are using modular AI courses to connect adult learners to practical, job-facing capabilities.

DigitalLEARNING

Worth Watching

Assessment integrity standards will tighten quickly

Expect regulators and accrediting bodies to demand explicit evidence that AI-era assessment still verifies independent learning.

Procurement language will shift toward control rights

District and university contracts are likely to specify AI defaults, override controls, and auditable policy enforcement.

Teacher mediation remains the success bottleneck

Systems scaling AI without sustained educator support will struggle to convert usage into learning gains.

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